

LittleReads

Ada's First Day of School

Life Skills

Ages 5–6

by LittleReads Editorial Team

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But she was still the same thing, and she felt the same way. The uniform that was a little bit too big.

Chapter 1: Butterfly Tummies

"I think there are butterflies in my tummy," Ada told her mother as they walked to school.

"Those are not real butterflies," said her mother with a smile. "They are feelings. Being nervous is normal. Everyone feels it."

"Even you, Mama?"

"Even me. Do you know what I do when I feel nervous? I take a deep breath and remind myself: I can do hard things."

Ada took a deep breath. "I can do hard things," she whispered to herself.

They reached the school gate. It was big and bright, with colourful drawings on the walls.

"Are you ready?" her mother asked.

Ada held her mother's hand tight. "I think so."

Chapter 2: New Faces

Inside the school, everything was new. New rooms. New smells. New sounds. And so many new faces!

Ada's teacher was Mrs. Okafor. She had a warm smile and kind eyes.

"Welcome, Ada!" she said. "We have been waiting for you."

Ada looked around the classroom. Other children were already sitting at small tables, drawing and talking.

A boy with a big grin waved at her. "Hi! My name is Chukwu. Do you want to sit next to me?"

Ada smiled for the first time that morning. "Yes, please," she said, and sat down.

Chapter 3: The Nervous Feeling

Mrs. Okafor showed the class how to write their names. Ada tried, but her letters were wobbly.

"I cannot do it," she whispered to Chukwu.

"It is okay," said Chukwu. "My letters were wobbly too. Mrs. Okafor says practice makes better."

Ada looked around. Some children were already writing neatly. Others were just like her, with wobbly letters and unsure hands.

"You are doing fine, Ada," said Mrs. Okafor, walking past. "Every expert started as a beginner."

That made Ada feel a little bit braver.

Chapter 4: Lunch and Laughter

At lunchtime, Ada and Chukwu sat together in the playground. They shared their snacks and talked about their favourite things.

"I like drawing," said Ada.

"I like building things," said Chukwu. "We should build something together!"

They laughed and played, and the nervous butterflies in Ada's tummy flew away without her even noticing.

When the bell rang, Ada was surprised. "Already? I thought it just started!"

Chukwu laughed. "That means you are having fun."

Chapter 5: Going Home

When Ada's mother came to pick her up, Ada ran to her with a big smile.

"Mama! School is fun! I made a friend! His name is Chukwu, and we are going to build things together!"

Her mother laughed. "And how are the butterflies?"

Ada thought about it. "They are gone! I did not even notice when they left!"

As they walked home, Ada held her mother's hand and told her about everything — the wobbly letters, the new classroom, the snacks, and the games.

That night, Ada put her new bag by the door, ready for tomorrow.

"I can do hard things," she said to herself. And she meant it.

What We Learned

- Feeling nervous is normal, and everyone experiences it.
- Taking deep breaths can help calm nervous feelings.
- Making friends makes new experiences easier and more fun.
- Practice makes things better, even if they start out wobbly.

Discussion Questions

1. How did Ada feel on her first day of school?
2. What helped Ada feel less nervous?
3. Have you ever been nervous about something new? What happened?

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Thank you for reading!

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